



Statistics for the SDGs - indicators for regional priorities

Name of the indicator	14.A.4 Outflow of heavy metals to the Baltic Sea
Sustainable Development Goal	Goal 14. Life below water
Priority	
Definition	Load of heavy metals introduced into the Baltic Sea with river runoff.
Unit	tonnes/year
Available dimensions	by metal
Methodological explanations	Water analysis is carried out basing on long-term environmental monitoring programs for particular voivodships. The charges of pollutants flowed by rivers into the Baltic Sea are presented on the basis of monitoring surveys of flowing surface waters in hydrological years. The hydrological year contains the period from 1 November to 31 October of the calendar year. River pollution runoff into the Baltic Sea – information comes from research conducted as part of the international Baltic Sea monitoring program, stemming from the Helsinki Convention. The Institute of Meteorology and Water Management (IMGW) provides substantive oversight of the research in Poland. Heavy metals are discharged into the Baltic Sea primarily via rivers and atmospheric deposition. They are introduced into the natural environment by human activity (industry and motorization, waste incineration, and the use of chemicals in agriculture), reaching the seas and oceans, where they undergo biochemical transformations and ultimately accumulate in bottom sediments.
Data source	Polish Waters National Water Holding / Statistics Poland
Data availability	Annual data, since 2012
Notes	
Data updated on	
Metadata updated on	